



**LIMITED
OPTIONS**

The military option could be a first move but it would certainly not be the last if Pakistan begins to retaliate.

**FRUSTRATION IS
MOUNTING AMONG
INDIANS OVER THE
MUMBAI ATTACKS**

and that the civilian and military leadership is pulling together. He asserts, "They both don't want a confrontation with India. Kiyani is trying to break the army out of the stereotypes and moulds that it is usually portrayed in." Ashley Tellis, a senior fellow at Carnegie, believes that Kiyani's assertion over the ISI was limited to telling the political leadership not to trample on what he considered the army's "prerogative." Nawaz discounts the notion that the Pakistan Army is keen to pull out of the Afghan front, stating that the war there is as important for the country's unity and integrity. Cohen agrees: "Moving troops from the Afghan border to the Indian front is like turning the Queen Elizabeth around—it would take a long time doing."

Yet many Indian experts believe there is much in the Mumbai attacks and its motivations that need explaining. They are convinced that Kiyani and Pakistan played a diabolical role in the attacks and their strategy will become more evident in the months ahead. India faces a major dilemma in its course of action. It wants the

Pakistani army to remain engaged on the Afghan front because it suits India to have the extremists tamed rather than fight in Kashmir. India also doesn't want to play into jihadi hands and create a crisis that would push the Pakistan Army to the forefront. Also, unlike in 2001 India realises it is not dealing with, "one Pakistan as it was under Musharraf. It has now become a conglomerate of institutions and individuals that has made it almost dysfunctional—a failed state." With so many divisive forces, Pakistan could easily implode.

Nor is India likely to be satisfied with assurances or token arrests of heads of terror groups. "We are not in the word business anymore. We need targeted response from Pakistan—we want to see outcomes and we are willing to think it through," said a senior official. He pointed out that the Bangladesh war, which dismembered Pakistan, took over a year of preparation. That included India making an international case for the refugees pouring across its borders, signing a treaty with Soviet